

Implementation Checklist

A practical checklist covering the key areas organisations should prepare for when moving from completed role grading to implementation.

Introduction

Completing a job evaluation exercise is only one part of the process. The real value comes when the outcomes are implemented in a way that is clear, fair, well governed, practical for managers and employees, and aligned to broader people processes.

Implementation is not only an administrative exercise. It usually also involves communication, change management, and review of people practices affected by the new grading outcomes. This checklist is designed to help organisations think about whether they are ready for that next phase.

1 Overall Implementation Readiness

Before implementation begins, consider the following:

- ☐ Have the final grading outcomes been approved?
- ☐ Is there a clear view of which roles and employees are affected?
- ☐ Is there agreement on who will oversee implementation?
- ☐ Are the main risks and sensitive areas understood?
- ☐ Is there enough internal readiness to communicate and manage the outcomes well?

2 Employee Mapping Readiness

A key part of implementation is deciding how employees will be aligned to evaluated roles. Before this begins, check that:

- ☐ there is a clear and current role library or approved role structure
- ☐ there is enough confidence in the role information available
- ☐ reporting lines and organisational structures are sufficiently clear
- ☐ internal decision-makers understand that mapping should focus on role content, not personal factors
- ☐ an agreed review process exists for unusual or unclear cases

3 Communication Readiness

Implementation can create uncertainty if people do not understand what is happening. Before communicating outcomes, check that:

- ☐ leaders are aligned on the purpose and messages
- ☐ managers are prepared to explain the process confidently
- ☐ employees will receive clear and consistent communication
- ☐ likely questions and concerns have been anticipated
- ☐ there is a plan for dealing with sensitive conversations respectfully

4 Manager Readiness

Managers often play the most visible role during implementation. Check whether managers are ready to:

- ☐ explain the context of the project
- ☐ discuss role outcomes clearly and calmly
- ☐ respond appropriately to initial employee concerns
- ☐ identify matters that need escalation
- ☐ support the organisation's chosen implementation approach

5 Governance Readiness

Implementation needs a level of governance that supports fairness and consistency. Check that:

- ☐ approval roles are clear
- ☐ escalation routes are understood
- ☐ there is a process for handling disagreements or appeals
- ☐ records of outcomes will be maintained
- ☐ decision-making responsibilities are understood across HR, leadership, and management

6 Change Management Readiness

Implementation is not only about new grades. It is also about helping people understand what the changes mean. Check whether the organisation is ready to:

- ☐ create awareness before individual discussions begin
- ☐ prepare leaders and employees for the transition
- ☐ build enough understanding to reduce confusion and resistance
- ☐ track themes and concerns emerging during rollout
- ☐ reinforce trust in the process over time

7 People Process Impact Readiness

New grading outcomes often affect more than one HR process. Consider whether the organisation has reviewed the impact on:

- ☐ remuneration structures
- ☐ pay ranges
- ☐ job architecture
- ☐ HR records and systems
- ☐ reporting and governance processes
- ☐ other people practices that use grades as an input

8 Compensation Readiness

Where grades influence reward structures, organisations should also think about compensation implications. Check whether there is readiness to review:

- ☐ how new grades link to salary structures
- ☐ whether there are employees above or below expected ranges
- ☐ whether reward conversations are clearly separated from grading conversations
- ☐ what governance will apply to any pay-related follow-up discussions

9 Final Readiness Questions

Before moving into implementation, ask:

- ☐ Are we ready to align employees to evaluated roles fairly?
- ☐ Are we ready to communicate outcomes clearly?
- ☐ Are we ready to support managers through the process?
- ☐ Are we ready to manage appeals or concerns consistently?
- ☐ Are we ready to understand the broader HR and reward implications?
- ☐ Are we ready to maintain trust throughout implementation?

FINAL NOTE

Strong implementation depends on more than correct grades. It depends on whether the organisation can apply outcomes consistently, communicate them credibly, manage sensitive issues well, and connect the results back into broader people and reward processes. That is why implementation should be approached as both a technical and a people process.

Want help implementing grading outcomes?

Book a working session and we'll help you apply outcomes in a practical, people-centred way, and assess your readiness for the next phase.

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Engage Job Evaluation is a methodology of Africa People Advisory Group (APAG). · engage.africapeopleadvisory.com